

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times



KIANA HAYERI FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Shrinking Horizons
Thousands of Afghan women have turned to entrepreneurship as the only path to make money and maintain a social life. Page A8.

Politics Stalls Driverless Cab In Many Cities

By DAVID McCABE
WASHINGTON — Late last year, a delegation from Waymo met with Gov. Kathy Hochul’s staff as she considered measures to legalize the company’s self-driving taxis in New York.
Waymo floated an idea: If New York allowed the company to offer driverless rides to the public, it could provide millions of dollars to benefit taxi drivers and other workers displaced by the technology, according to three people with knowledge of the discussions. The proposed funding amounted to about \$20 million, one of the people said.

But Waymo still failed to head off opposition to its technology from labor groups. Ms. Hochul, a Democrat, introduced a budget proposal in January that would have allowed Waymo to operate in much of the state, excluding the biggest market, New York City. A month later, she withdrew her support after an outcry from groups that represent drivers, who quickly declared victory.
“Billionaire tech bosses underestimate workers at their own peril,” said Bhairavi Desai, the executive director of the New York Taxi Workers Alliance.
Waymo is increasingly facing political roadblocks as it tries to roll out its self-driving taxis powered by artificial intelligence nationwide. After early successes winning over politicians in California — its home state — and elsewhere, Waymo has stumbled in unlocking some of the biggest markets in the country.

New York abandoned its proposal to allow self-driving taxis earlier this year. New York City’s new mayor, Zohran Mamdani, has said he would heavily weigh the interests of taxi drivers in deciding on rules for the technology. In Illinois, legislation to authorize the service stalled after labor unions protested. And in Washington, the city’s Council has for years delayed a decision about whether to allow robo-taxis.
Those places and others are central to Waymo’s expansion plans as the company pushes its vehicles onto new roads, according to industry analysts and experts. Waymo recently received \$16 billion in new funding from investors for expansion, and the

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Matty Matheson loves his role on “The Bear” and life on his Canadian farm, but he’s weary of playing the clown. PAGE D8



THE WEATHER

Today, warmer, less humid, mostly sunny, high 81. Tonight, mainly clear, low 64. Tomorrow, partly cloudy, low humidity, high 81. Weather map appears on Page B8.

NEWS ANALYSIS

10 Years Later, Brexit Feeling Like Albatross

Political Turmoil and Economic Pain Persist

By MICHAEL D. SHEAR and MEGAN SPECIA

LONDON — A decade ago, British voters went to the polls with a singular image fresh in their minds: a ubiquitous red bus, the hallmark of the Brexit campaign, imploring residents of the once sprawling empire to “take back control” by severing ties to Europe.

By a slim margin on June 23, 2016, Britons voted to leave the European Union. The people, politicians and businesses of the United Kingdom have been reckoning with the consequences of that decision ever since. Trade, travel, work, study, taxes, borders, the price of groceries, national pride — almost no part of life escaped untouched by the Brexit referendum in the 10 years since the votes were cast.

On Monday, the forces of Brexit claimed their latest political victim, when Prime Minister Keir Starmer announced his resignation, becoming the sixth British leader since the referendum whose tenure was cut short. While he made unforced errors, he was also felled by a series of challenges established long before he arrived in office.

The economy is sluggish, a condition economists attribute to the effects of severing ties with Europe, along with the enduring consequences of the 2008 global financial crisis, which drove up government debt, and the Covid-19 pandemic. Opportunities to work and live abroad are more limited. Travel is frustrating. Trade with Europe has continued but at a lower level, with British exports to the bloc down about 12 percent, according to the Centre for European Reform, a research group.

Immigration from outside the European Union went way up for a time, after the then-Conservative government tried to fill worker shortages in health care and home care, and foreign students were welcomed by cash-poor British universities. But after the rise caused voter anger, the government introduced new restrictions on migration, and it has since fallen sharply.

Perhaps no part of British society was changed more by Brexit than its political landscape, which has fractured into a chaotic tug of war in which no party seems able to satisfy the demands of an angry and disillusioned electorate.

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VANCE BALANCING DISRUPTIVE BOSS AND A WILY RIVAL

THORNY ROLE ON IRAN

Savior or a Scapegoat as Accounts Conflict on Envoys’ Progress

By TYLER PAGER

WASHINGTON — As Vice President JD Vance entered the fifth hour of negotiations with Iranian leaders over the weekend, President Trump weighed in with an ill-timed threat to start bombing again.

If the Iranians closed the Strait of Hormuz, Mr. Trump told a Fox News reporter, the negotiators talking to Mr. Vance would never make it back to their country — in fact, they would have no country to return to at all.

For Mr. Vance, this was the latest example of his increasingly tricky role as the frontman in the U.S. negotiations with Iran, as Mr. Trump repeatedly creates disruptions in his path.

On Monday, Mr. Vance said the first round of talks had laid “a successful foundation” for peace. But now, Mr. Vance will have to find a way to end a war that he opposed at the start, while navigating his boss’s whims and an adversary that has proved itself, at least in part, immune to Mr. Trump’s threats.

“What we told the Iranians yesterday is when you guys engage in what us millennials might call trash talk, you can’t expect the president of the United States not to respond and not to correct the record,” he said on Monday at a news conference. “So when they say things that aren’t true, the president is going to respond to it.”

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POOL PHOTO BY NATHAN HOWARD

JD Vance is in a difficult spot as the frontman on Iran.

WAR POWERS A vote in the Senate delivered a bipartisan rebuke to the president on Iran. PAGE A9

Host Cities and Soccer Squads Locked in a Mutual Embrace

By JESSE MCKINLEY and SCOTT CACCIOLA

Riley Sealander, a 26-year-old barista in Greensboro, N.C., is your typically rabid World Cup fan. He wears his favorite team’s jersey and watches its matches as he makes cappuccinos. He drapes the red, white and blue around his workplace and tries hard to rally new supporters to fledgling fan clubs.

But Sealander isn’t promoting the U.S. team. Instead, he’s all-in on Team Norway, whose arrival this month in Greensboro set off a communitywide embrace of the Scandinavian squad, merging Southern hospitality with a bona fide enthusiasm for one of Europe’s trendiest teams after it picked the city as its temporary home.

“We’re not in Raleigh, we’re not Charlotte,” said Sealander, wearing a customized Norway jersey

under his apron, “so it was kind of a big deal.”

Since teams began decamping to the United States earlier this month, that mix of small-city pride and the global reach of international soccer has led to an unlikely romance between everyday Americans and squads from around the world, a juxtaposition of diverse cultures that has sparked moments of joy — like a goal in stoppage time — in both hosts and visitors alike.

This weekslong love affair has been seen in bigger match locations like Boston, where jubilant, and thirsty, Scottish fans have been drinking the town dry and posting emotional videos about their renewed faith in the American dream. Argentines, known for their steak, have been sighted

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ON THE WEB

High-Stakes Primaries

Races in New York tested the power of progressive Democrats, and Utah, Maryland and South Carolina also held contests. Coverage is at nytimes.com.

SPORTS B6-9

Inside a Blockbuster Trade

A deal for the Bucks’ Giannis Antetokounmpo went through after five months of maneuvering. PAGE B7

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